

Rajesh Dammala

Manager, Technical Support — Escalation Leadership, SLA Operations & Team Coaching

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Morrisville, NC (Raleigh-area; on-site ready)

<https://rdammala.github.io/Litera> [Manager-Technical-Support/](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical support and operations leader with 16+ years in mission-critical, SLA-driven environments, leading teams of 15-32 across global locations. Combines escalation ownership, operational rigor, and coaching to drive performance, accountability, and continuous improvement. Deep expertise in CSAT/FCR/SLA/MTTR metrics, root-cause analysis, KCS-aligned knowledge management, and support tooling (Salesforce Service Cloud, Jira, ServiceNow). Recognized for calm, clear leadership during high-pressure escalations and for building durable support cultures grounded in empathy and accountability.

CAREER SNAPSHOT

16+ Years in IT / Cloud / Reliability Engineering
100% SLA Across 20+ Mission-Critical Services
30-35% Incidents Auto-Resolved via AI Automation
25,000+ Stale Incidents Eliminated
85% → 98% Operational Efficiency Lift
15-32 Engineers Led Across Global Teams

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced issue-resolution time 32% and lifted operational efficiency from 85% to 98% through escalation-framework redesign.
- Eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ redundant alerts, sharpening queue health and reducing alert fatigue ~90%.
- Maintained 100% SLA across 20+ mission-critical services in a 24/7/365 support organization.
- Authored 175+ playbooks/KB articles in 5 months, accelerating onboarding and case quality.
- Led and mentored global support teams of 15-32 engineers across the US and India.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Support Leadership: Team Coaching & Development, Player-Coach Leadership, Onboarding & Enablement, Manager on Duty (MOD), Performance Management

Escalation & SLA Ops: Customer Escalation Ownership, SLA / MTTR Management, Queue & Backlog Health, Reopen & Aging Analysis, Risk Intervention

Support Tools: Salesforce Service Cloud, Jira, ServiceNow, Azure DevOps, ICM

Quality & Metrics: CSAT, First Contact Resolution, KPI Tracking, Root-Cause Analysis, QA Programs

Process & Knowledge: ITIL-aligned Processes, KCS-aligned Knowledge Mgmt, Playbooks & Runbooks, Continuous Improvement

Technical: Microsoft Azure, M365, PowerShell, GenAI Tooling, AI-Assisted Support Automation

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Customer Escalation & SLA Management — Expert
Team Coaching & People Leadership — Expert
Support Operations & Metrics (CSAT/FCR/MTTR) — Expert
Salesforce Service Cloud / Jira / ServiceNow — Advanced
Root-Cause Analysis & Continuous Improvement — Expert
KCS-aligned Knowledge Management — Advanced
GenAI-Assisted Support Automation — Advanced
Cross-functional Stakeholder Management — Expert

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Escalations & Technical Support Manager — Xbox Customer Experience (CXT)

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) | Redmond, WA | May 2021 - Present

Leadership-level player-coach for a 24/7/365 mission-critical support organization serving millions of users.

- Own customer escalations as the primary leadership point for high-impact, high-risk issues; built clear Who/What/When escalation plans and intervened early on SLA-breach risk.
- Coach and develop technical support engineers across experience levels — 1:1s, performance check-ins, onboarding, and targeted enablement to raise case quality and ownership.
- Oversee daily support operations: queue health, workload distribution, backlog, aging cases, and reopen trends; lead operational reviews to prioritize actions.
- Drove operational efficiency from 85% to 98% and reduced resolution time 32% via escalation-framework redesign and root-cause analysis.
- Champion knowledge management — authored 175+ playbooks/KB articles in 5 months; supported GenAI tool adoption while holding quality standards.
- Act as liaison across Engineering, Product, CloudOps, and Account teams in cross-functional escalations and risk discussions; eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ alerts.

Azure Support Technical Lead — Customer Support Services

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 - May 2021

Led a 15-engineer enterprise support team in an SLA-driven environment.

- Led 15 engineers delivering enterprise customer support; set clear expectations for ownership, communication, and case quality.
- Owned high-risk customer escalations end-to-end with empathetic, timely communication; partnered with Engineering and Product on systemic fixes.
- Tracked CSAT, first-contact-resolution, reopen rates, and SLA adherence; implemented improvement plans from KPI and root-cause trends.
- Spearheaded an Azure Chat Support platform launch, improving customer time-to-resolution and support coverage.

Operations Lead — Azure Live Site Operations

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India | May 2012 - Nov 2016

Led 12 senior + 20 service engineers operating mission-critical services at 99.95%+ SLA.

- Managed distributed support/operations teams across Hyderabad and Redmond; mentored engineers from specialists to technical leads.
- Built PowerShell automation saving thousands of manual hours annually; standardized

documentation and operational procedures.

- Led incident, problem, and change management within ITIL-aligned operations; filed 200+ bugs/improvements during platform onboarding.

Systems Analyst / Support Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 - Nov 2011

Enterprise support and infrastructure operations.

- Provided technical support across enterprise server and infrastructure environments; executed migrations and patch deployments.
- Documented procedures and resolved recurring issues through systemic process improvements.

SELECTED PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES

Escalation Framework Redesign — Rebuilt Who/What/When escalation plans and early SLA-risk intervention, cutting resolution time 32% and improving customer communication consistency.

Knowledge & Enablement Engine — Authored 175+ playbooks/KB articles and onboarding paths in 5 months, raising first-contact resolution and case quality.

GenAI-Assisted Support — Piloted GenAI tooling and an AI incident agent (30-35% auto-resolution) while holding tone, accuracy, and documentation standards.

Operational Excellence Program — Drove queue health, backlog, and reopen-trend reviews lifting efficiency 85% to 98% and eliminating 25,000+ stale incidents.

LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

- Led and mentored global teams of 15-32 engineers across the US and India, growing individual contributors into technical leads.
- Central escalation authority and SME for high-severity incidents, coordinating Security, Engineering, Product, and business teams under pressure.
- Ran 1:1s, performance reviews, onboarding, and targeted coaching/enablement plans; built psychologically safe, high-accountability culture.
- Synthesized incident and reliability data into executive reviews driving investment and process decisions.
- Early operationalizer of AI/automation in production support and operations; champion of continuous learning.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified IT Professional — Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- Microsoft AZ-900 — Azure Fundamentals
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations
- Google — Introduction to Generative AI
- TechMahindra AI White Belt

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering, JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

PROFESSIONAL PHILOSOPHY

Great support leadership is coaching, not rescuing. I hold the line on standards while staying empathetic and customer-focused, empower teams to own complexity, and think beyond individual cases to long-term operational and cultural impact.